Ajay Singh Shekhawat

Lead Backend Engineer | Java | Spring Boot | Distributed Systems
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Lead Backend Engineer with 7+ years of experience building and operating production backend systems, including high-throughput pricing systems.
Experienced in Java, distributed systems, streaming platforms, and cloud-native infrastructure, with hands-on ownership of business-critical services, migrations, and production incident handling.

Education

B. Tech in Civil Engineering with minor in Computer Science Engineering from IIT Gandhinagar. **[2014 – 2018]**

Work Experience

Tech Lead at Walmart (IN4) (Price Engine) : [Feb 2024 – Current]

- **Delivered** feature changes in the **Price Engine** backend handling **~10M price updates daily on average**, ensuring correctness and stability for pricing-critical workflows.
- **Owned Timeline Keeper (TLK)** post design finalization, building new backend modules with audit and metrics, leading to decommissioning of a legacy item store and offboarding of **~100M item–store mappings.**
- **Led** MPS onboarding from POC to production, implementing required changes to support message ingestion via HTTP POST–based APIs.
- **Provided** design guidance and conducted code reviews across teams, driving consistency, reliability, and shared architectural standards for pricing services.

SDE2 at Walmart (IN3) (Clearance Markdown): [June 2021 – Jan 2024]

- **Led** end-to-end design and implementation of a high-throughput (~50 million records) streaming service.
- **Migrated** a legacy mainframe job to BigQuery in collaboration with multiple teams, improving scalability and simplifying data access by eliminating Spark-based processing.
- **Built** a Cassandra core common library adopted across 19 repositories to standardize data access patterns and reduce repeated scalability and correctness issues across teams.
- **Designed** a Kafka-over-Cassandra storage pattern to reduce scalability issues during inter-service data transfer.
- **Delivered** pricing features including budget, weighted average, and prime item handling while enforcing code quality via testing and Sonar adoption.
- **Restored** availability of pricing-critical systems by leading production incident response using business context and system-level debugging under tight timelines.

SDE1 at InMobi Marketing Cloud (CDP): [Jan 2020 – Jan 2021]

- **Identified** and implemented improvements in the custom Cosmos auto-scaler, resulting in cost savings and smoother scaling of the Cosmos DB.
- **Migrated** 4+ services from Service Fabric to Azure Kubernetes Service.
- **Automated** metadata refresh pipeline using Azure ADF, ensuring timely updates for data enrichment processes.
- **Integrated** backend systems with CDP UI for various projects. Tasks included updating IAM APIs, creating new flows, and modifying existing ones to enhance system functionality.

SDE1 at Prism (Data Platform): [June 2018 – Dec 2020]

- **Built** and operated Kafka-to-Hive ingestion pipelines handling GB–TB scale datasets, addressing schema evolution, JSON transformations, and high-volume data challenges.
- **Contributed** to the transition from monolithic to microservices architecture by configuring and operating Presto for low-latency analytical queries.
- **Managed** and extended a data platform ecosystem including Airflow orchestration, Druid (POC for sub-second analytics), and automated Sqoop-based Hive synchronization.

Skill Set

- **Languages & Frameworks** : Java (Spring-Boot, Spring), Python, Shell
- **APIs & Service Design**: REST APIs, Microservices
- **Streaming & Data**: Kafka, Cassandra, BigQuery, Hive, Presto, Spark, Druid
- **Databases**: MySQL, Postgres, MSSQL, MongoDB, Cosmos DB
- **Cloud & Infrastructure** : Kubernetes, GCP, AWS, Azure, Hybrid / In-house Platforms
- **Tools & Platforms**: Airflow, Azure Data Factory (ADF), Pub/Sub, HDFS, S3, GCS, Sqoop